

BOBBY T. HICKEY

Operations Leader in Aggregates and Mining · **Disruptive Depths, ai in heavy industry**

Mead, OK | bhickey_78@yahoo.com | linkedin.com/in/bobbythickey

SUMMARY

Operations leader with 15+ years of progressive experience across aggregates production and heavy industrial manufacturing. Started as a welder and earned every step to production management. Proven across the full quarry leadership stack: crew development, budget ownership, maintenance planning, quality execution, and safety leadership in MSHA regulated and union environments.

EXPERIENCE

Vulcan Materials Company | Southwest Division, Southern Oklahoma

Production Supervisor

Oct 2025 to Present

- Run production across the wash plant, dredge, and pond fines at a multi million ton per year aggregates operation, leading a crew of 8 with direct accountability for throughput, labor efficiency, and yield KPIs.
- Consistently deliver production and yield targets month over month across the wet processing side of the plant.
- Drive a strong safety culture through pre shift huddles, JSAs, near miss reporting, and MSHA ready documentation.
- Build and hold my own area budget, tracking in line with plan through the year, and coordinate with vendors and supply teams to maintain parts availability and reduce downtime risk.
- Turn crew inspection lists into prioritized work orders, plan major downtime projects with the plant manager and other supervisors, lead crew maintenance during down hours, and launched RCA discipline so corrective actions get completed and shared.

Caterpillar Inc. | Denison, TX

Production Manager

Sep 2023 to Sep 2025

- Ran the fabrication value stream in a union facility, including the team that builds the **Cat MD6 surface mining drill**: 40 employees, managing both the people and the budget through an annual blanket PO I negotiated to run the shop.
- Hit **97 percent Rolling Business Model attainment** with higher production year over year using fewer people, while holding overtime under 10 percent and labor hours justified against machine hours every month and quarter.
- Led the fabrication team to the **first recorded world class welders at under 10,000 DPM**, and owned Built In Quality execution: containment and corrective plans for line defects, with field defect fixes verified across every machine in the plant.
- Applied Human and Organizational Performance principles and led SIF and PSIF response, convening safety, engineering, and quality to run fishbone and RCCA and implement prevention plans.
- Increased employee engagement 15 percent through coaching, development, and consistent standards, and drove 5S, Lean, Six Sigma, and CQMS/ISO across the operation.

Operations Section Manager, 2nd Shift

Feb 2023 to Sep 2023

- Managed three value streams to takt time with a crew of 20, **increasing second shift productivity 30 percent** through continuous improvement and cross shift communication.

Dolese Bros. Co. | Coleman, OK

Leadman, Plant Operations

Sep 2020 to Feb 2023

- Led plant maintenance as leadman on nights, then days: prioritized the maintenance list, directed contractors on nightly work priorities, and scheduled downtime repairs to meet production goals across crushers, conveyors, and processing equipment.
- **Reduced downtime 30 percent** through improved troubleshooting and proactive maintenance, developed preventive and predictive maintenance programs, and worked with vendors to implement new processes that extended equipment life and improved plant efficiency.
- Tasked and trained operations and maintenance employees, pairing them with contractors and working alongside them myself so the crew learned maintenance hands on, building bench strength on purpose.
- Sat in monthly P&L reviews with the supervisor and superintendent, answering for production and downtime: where it occurred and why.
- Led the Near Miss Safety Program for three years and ensured full MSHA and OSHA compliance through inspections and best practice enforcement.

Welder / Head Welder

Nov 2015 to Sep 2020

- Oversaw all plant welding needs and several major capital upgrades; performed electrical and precision mechanical maintenance including motor and centrifugal pump alignment, screen unit repairs, and conveyor repairs.

CREDENTIALS AND SKILLS

- Six Sigma Green Belt | Associate in Business Administration, Grayson College: Summa Cum Laude, 4.0 GPA, President's Award
- MSHA regulated operations | Union workforce leadership | SAP | HOP | RCCA and fishbone | KPI system design | Maintenance planning and contractor management